

5.1 Simple Text Editors And Utilities

A common crib about Linux is that there aren't many applications written for it. But one only needs to take a look at the myriad of applications that come with the bigger distributions—SuSe, Red Hat and Fedora. Office applications, image editors, multimedia—they're all there. The K Desktop Environment (KDE) package contents are organised under suitable headings in what appears like a Windows Start Menu.

Apart from Open Office, there are plenty of small tools that come in handy for various personal and even office purposes. In KDE, for example, you have floating sticky notes called KNotes, where you can jot down, well, notes. This being a scribble pad, you don't need to save any files—the text you typed in is retained. There is also a feature-rich alarm, which can even send out e-mails! At the scheduled time, the alarm can open up an image or a text file.

Need to make a quick calculation? You have a quick and easy-to-use calculator called KCalc. As you've guessed, applications whose names start with "K" are part of the KDE package. Gnome includes its own calculator that is called simply *Calculator*.

Came across a word you're not familiar with? There is Kdict for you, a dictionary (in KDE, of course, in the Applications Menu.). In Gnome, you can find a dictionary in the *Applications > Accessories* menu. Both these calculators look up an online dictionary.

5.1.1 gedit

The Gnome equivalent of Kword is gedit, the default basic word editor. We liked the look and feel of gedit better than Kword, but of course, this is subjective.

On the functionality side, there are icons at the top of the window that you can use for the basic copy and paste operations, and also a Find and Replace icon! The Edit menu throws a nice surprise